GRiddles Submission: Gamma Cirques

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Problem Statement

Who was the softball champion?

Solution

1. First Realisation

The first realisation I came to was that the number 12.17.15.2.19 is a date in the Mayan calendar, around 12 October 1968. From this I was able to reason that all the shown numbers represent different years,

- 12.17.15.2.19 - 1968 in the Mayan Calendar
- REIWA2 - 2020 in the Japanese Calendar
- SHOWA39 - 1964 in the Japenese Calendar
- 4705 - 2008 in the Chinese Calendar
- 695.4 - 2004 in the Greek Olympiad Calendar
- 2713 - 1960 in the Roman Calendar

2. Second Realisation

The Chinese 2008 and Japanese 2020 gave it away for me that the calendar used in each of these dates correspond to the olympic host in that year (with the Mayan calendar being used for modern day Mexico). This allowed me to construct the 'decrypted' image,

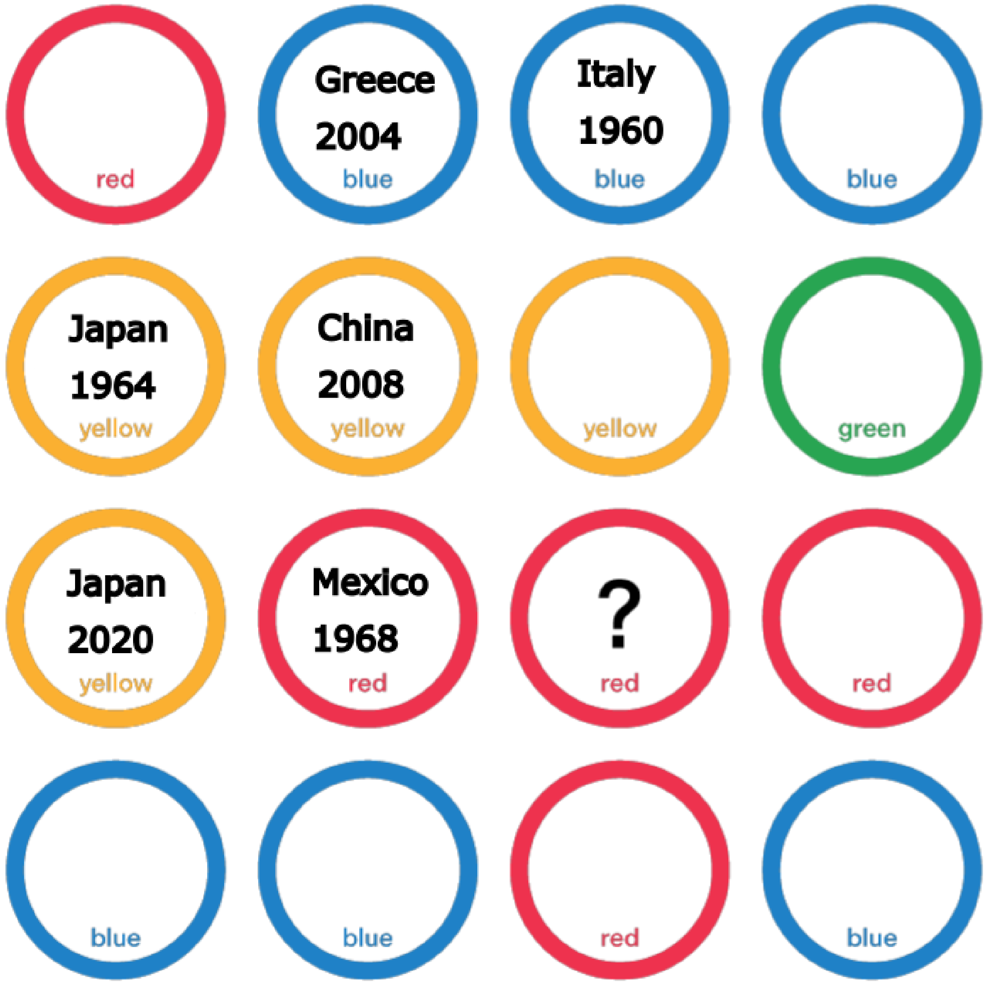

Figure 1: The decrypted image showing years and host countries

3. Final Realisation

Since this problem centres around the Olympics, I gathered that the circle with the question mark represents some as yet unknown Olympic games and I am supposed to identify the gold medal winners for that particular year. Softball has only been played 5 times (so far) at the Olympics, in the years 1996, 2000, 2004, 2008, 2020. The years 2008, 2020, and 2004 are already accounted for, so the winner must be from either the 2000 or the 1996 Olympic games.

I then noticed the colours of the rings correspond to the colours of the Olympic rings, which represent the 5 continents.

This allowed me to identify the 2000 Australian Olympic games as the subject of the green circle.

The final, question marked red circle therefore corresponds to the 1996 Olympic Games in Atlanta, Georgia.

4. Final Answer

In 1996, the Softball gold medal was won by the United states, giving me the final answer,

Final Answer:
The US softball team won gold at the 1996 Olympics.